

GAMIFIED ILLUSIONS

Why Abundance Means New Masters

Part One - Accelerationist Lie

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Elisabeth Roberts

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We used to look up at the night sky to make wishes, hunt shooting stars, or get existential about our place in the universe. Now? The robots do our laundry, the AI handles our taxes, and nanobots fix our liver while we nap. Food extrudes from smart printers, asteroid mining beams down infinite resources, and we— proud citizens of the techno future — are finally free.

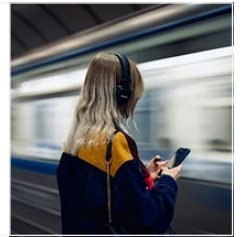
Free to do what, exactly?

Well... mostly to rent everything we need from a tiny class of trillionaires who own the robots, the nanobots, the asteroid mining rigs, the food printers, the cloud, and the orbital defense platforms in case we get any silly ideas about *revolution*. Dopamine levels are regulated, our fridge reorders oat milk automatically, and the Netflix algorithm has 37 new seasons of our favorite show. Welcome to the *Accelerationist Utopia*. The belief that if we supercharge technological progress through AI, automation, space expansion, and ubiquitous computation, we can punch through the stubborn ceiling of scarcity and build a post-work, post-need civilization.

Accelerationism to Human Irrelevance

Promised Jetpacks, Gave Us Gig Work and Surveillance

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But beneath the shiny layer of exponential graphs and breathless TED Talks, there lurks an unexamined contradiction: *who owns the engines of acceleration?* And why should they share the spoils? Who engineers that? Should we believe the same actors who profit now will allow this transition? Why do billionaires/trillionaires or states not just capture the gains of acceleration forever? Tech abundance doesn't automatically equate to freedom; it can produce learned helplessness, attention traps, or addiction. How do planetary limits factor in? Or do we assume tech solves them faster than they break?

The myth has deep roots. Marx imagined the forces of production outgrowing the constraints of feudal ownership. Later, cyberneticians and techno-optimists envisioned vast automated systems, “*fully automated luxury communism*” for the masses. Today, the dream is reborn in the language of Silicon Valley: AGI, nanotechnology, universal basic income, asteroid mining — *infinite resources, infinite upgrades, infinite growth*.

USA Decline is a Business Model

A Guillotine for Everyone Else

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But the vision is silent about the simple fact that technology does not distribute itself. It is owned, developed, and deployed by people and institutions with specific interests. And history shows that when new productive powers emerge (whether it's steam, electricity, or the microchip the default trajectory is *not* egalitarian. It is enclosed. Whoever controls the means of acceleration controls the wealth it generates.

Faster tech → greater returns to scale → more capital concentration → greater ability to steer and defend future tech.

It's a beautiful story. Until we ask one pesky question: *"Who owns the goddamn robots?"* Spoiler: it's probably not us.

Land? Enclosed. Railroads? Enclosed. The Internet? Started open, got enclosed. Now AI: same story, just faster. Billionaires — shocking news — **like fences. They like patents. They like rents. They like us needing them.**

The Elites Are Losing Control

America was just Unfollowed

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Even the “open source” dream is often a mirage. Open-source code still needs servers, supply chains, chips, and energy. Try running our unstoppable decentralized AI model when the GPU mines are all owned by MegaCorp and the local grid is turned off because we forgot to pay for our cloud subscription.

From Google's surveillance empire to OpenAI's shift from nonprofit to capped-profit to de facto corporate arm, the pattern is so common it should be axiomatic: the faster and bigger the system, the greater the temptation and capacity to enclose it.

Sometimes they counter this by pointing to decentralization: DAOs, open-source AI models, crypto protocols. In theory, these tools create incorruptible, distributed systems that no single actor can dominate. But this techno-utopian argument is mostly superficial. Power always finds new break points. Even decentralized networks have economies of scale. Running massive AI models takes server farms and energy grids that few can afford. Governance tokens accrue in the hands of early whales and big capital. Smart contracts are only as fair as the humans who design, update, and interpret them. And enforcement is toothless if the physical infrastructure — the mining rigs, the satellites, the drones — is privately owned.

Will We Survive the Digital Feudal Ages?

AI Servants or Modern Slaves?

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In the real world, the blockchain may be unstoppable, but the servers hosting the miners are not. There is always an off-switch somewhere — and billionaires know where to find it.

So if this techno dream delivers on its promise of exponential abundance, but the means of production remain enclosed, what does that future look like?

Not a digital Eden. It is an empire of *tech kings and slaves*:

- The kings are those who own the keys to the productive algorithms, the labs, the resource flows, and the orbital high grounds.
- The slaves are not chained to machines in the old sense — they are made dependent through soft coercion: algorithmic control, surveillance incentives, digital debt, or total reliance on proprietary platforms for food, housing, and energy.

We might have a universal basic income, but it is calibrated to keep us docile, not free. Our choices are gamified illusions.

The “exit options” are gated by the same platforms that sell us our freedom in monthly subscriptions. Not citizens of abundance. We are clients. Dependents. Tenants on someone else's digital estate.

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AI

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Written by Elisabeth Roberts

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